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SUPPLEMENTARY PARTIAL EUROPEAN SEARCH REPORT

under Rule 164, paragraph 1 of the European Patent Convention

Application Number
EP 21 91 1901

DOCUMENTS CONSIDERED TO BE RELEVANT

Category	Citation of document with indication, where appropriate, of relevant passages	Relevant to claim	CLASSIFICATION OF THE APPLICATION (IPC)
Y	WO 2019/067092 A1 (UNIV JOHNS HOPKINS [US] ET AL.) 4 April 2019 (2019-04-04) * the whole document * * claims 9-15, 18-24, 27-33 * -----	1-15	INV. G01N33/574 A61B5/00 C12Q1/6886 G01N33/50
Y	WO 2017/004243 A1 (CARIS SCIENCE INC [US]) 5 January 2017 (2017-01-05) * the whole document * * pages 110-111, paragraphs 41,47; table 4 * -----	1-15	G06N20/00 G16B25/00 G16B40/00 G16B40/20 G16H50/20
Y	US 2016/069889 A1 (SPETZLER DAVID [US] ET AL) 10 March 2016 (2016-03-10) * the whole document * -----	1-15	
Y	US 2016/238616 A1 (MASSON LINDI [ZA] ET AL) 18 August 2016 (2016-08-18) * the whole document * -----	1-15	
Y	WO 2019/200410 A1 (FREENOME HOLDINGS INC [US]) 17 October 2019 (2019-10-17) * the whole document * -----	1-15	
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TECHNICAL FIELDS SEARCHED (IPC)

G06F
G16B

LACK OF UNITY OF INVENTION

The Search Division considers that the present European patent application does not comply with the requirements of unity of invention and relates to several inventions or groups of inventions, namely:

see sheet B

The present partial supplementary European search report has been drawn up for those parts of the European patent application which relate to the invention first mentioned in the claims.

Place of search	Date of completion of the search	Examiner
The Hague	27 September 2024	Boiangiu, Clara

CATEGORY OF CITED DOCUMENTS

X : particularly relevant if taken alone
Y : particularly relevant if combined with another document of the same category
A : technological background
O : non-written disclosure
P : intermediate document

T : theory or principle underlying the invention
E : earlier patent document, but published on, or after the filing date
D : document cited in the application
L : document cited for other reasons

& : member of the same patent family, corresponding document

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EPO FORM 1503 03.82 (P04N23)

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SUPPLEMENTARY PARTIAL EUROPEAN SEARCH REPORT

Application Number
EP 21 91 1901

DOCUMENTS CONSIDERED TO BE RELEVANT

Category	Citation of document with indication, where appropriate, of relevant passages	Relevant to claim
Y	LI JINGJING ET AL: "The Role of Interleukins in Colorectal Cancer", INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES, vol. 16, no. 13, 1 January 2020 (2020-01-01), pages 2323-2339, XP093110139, ISSN: 1449-2288, DOI: 10.7150/ijbs.46651 * the whole document *	1-15
Y	Knuchel Sarah ET AL: "Fibroblast surface-associated FGF-2 promotes contactdependent colorectal cancer cell migration and invasion through FGFR-SRC signaling and integrin [alpha] v [beta] 5 -mediated adhesion", Oncotarget, Advance Publications, 5 May 2015 (2015-05-05), XP093209377, Retrieved from the Internet: URL:https://www.oncotarget.com/article/3883/pdf/ * the whole document *	1-15
Y	KORBECKI JAN ET AL: "Fractalkine/CX3CL1 in Neoplastic Processes", INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF MOLECULAR SCIENCES, vol. 21, no. 10, 25 May 2020 (2020-05-25), page 3723, XP093209378, Basel, CH ISSN: 1422-0067, DOI: 10.3390/ijms21103723 * the whole document *	1-15

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CLASSIFICATION OF THE APPLICATION (IPC)

TECHNICAL FIELDS SEARCHED (IPC)

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SUPPLEMENTARY PARTIAL EUROPEAN SEARCH REPORT

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Y	GIULIO C SPAGNOLI ET AL: "FLT3 ligand gene expression and protein production in human colorectal cancer cell lines and clinical tumor specimens", INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF CANCER, JOHN WILEY & SONS, INC, US, vol. 86, no. 2, 28 March 2000 (2000-03-28), pages 238-243, XP071279304, ISSN: 0020-7136, DOI: 10.1002/(SICI)1097-0215(20000415)86:2<238::AID-IJC13>3.0.CO;2-X * the whole document *	1-15
Y	MESSA CATERINA ET AL: "EGF, TGF-a, and EGF-R in Human Colorectal Adenocarcinoma", ACTA ONCOLOGICA., vol. 37, no. 3, 1 January 1998 (1998-01-01), pages 285-289, XP093209381, GB ISSN: 0284-186X, DOI: 10.1080/028418698429595 * the whole document *	1-15
A	US 2019/300964 A1 (ZHANG KANG [US] ET AL) 3 October 2019 (2019-10-03) * the whole document *	1-15
A	US 2012/143805 A1 (GOLD LARRY [US] ET AL) 7 June 2012 (2012-06-07) * the whole document *	1-15

CLASSIFICATION OF THE APPLICATION (IPC)

TECHNICAL FIELDS SEARCHED (IPC)

EPO FORM 1503 09.98 (P04N26)

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LACK OF UNITY OF INVENTION
SHEET B

Application Number
EP 21 91 1901

The Search Division considers that the present European patent application does not comply with the requirements of unity of invention and relates to several inventions or groups of inventions, namely:

1. claims: 1-15(partially)

Invention 1.1 Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 following proteins: EGF, FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2.
Invention 1.2 Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 following proteins: FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2, CA19-9.
Inventions 1.3-1.28 Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 proteins selected from the following panel: FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2, CA19-9, CEA, , HGF, OPN, CA125, AFP, CA15-3, CEACAM, CYFRA21-1, CA125, Kallikrein 6, Mesothelin, HE4, MIF, angiopoietin-2, mesothelin, MMP-2, TFMP1-2, tenascin C, Apo Al, factor H, AGRP
Invention 1.29 Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 following proteins: TFMP1-2, tenascin C, Apo Al, factor H, AGRP, fetuin A.

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2. claims: 1-15(partially)

Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising:measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 following proteins: FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2, IL-6.

3-39. claims: 1-15(partially)

Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising:measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising at least 6 of proteins selected from the group consisting of: FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2, IL-6, IL-8, GROa, MIP-3a, Complement component C2, Complement component C9, Factor D, Factor I, MBL, MMP-2, GDF-15, Osteonectin, Periostin, ANGPTL4, FGF-21, FGF-23, HGF, Angiopoietin-2, BMP-9, IL-1RII, HGFR, IL-6ra, OPN, Tenascin-C,

The Search Division considers that the present European patent application does not comply with the requirements of unity of invention and relates to several inventions or groups of inventions, namely:

Thrombospondin-2, uPAR, CD44, Kallikrein-6, Mesothelin, EpCAM, Apo A1, AGP, A2MB, Fetuin A, HP, L-Selectin, Complement component C1q, Complement component C3, Complement component C3b, Factor B, Factor H, Properdin, AGRP, MMP-12, CYFRA21-1, HE4, total PSA, MIF, AFP, CA125, CA19-9, CA15-3 (MUC-1).

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40. claims: 1-15(partially)

Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 proteins selected from the group consisting of: total PSA, EGF, FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a.

The search has been limited to the first subject.

Reference is made to the following documents:
D1: WO 2019/067092
D11: US 2019/300964
D12: US 2012/143805
This Authority considers that the application does not meet the requirements of unity of invention and that there are 40 inventions covered by the claims indicated as follows:
Invention 1: claims:1-15(partially):
Invention 1.1 Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 following proteins: EGF, FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2.
Inventions 1.2-1.28 Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 proteins selected from the following panel: FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2, CA19-9, CEA, , HGF, OPN, CA125, AFP, CA15-3, CEACAM, CYFRA21-1, CA125, Kallikrein 6, Mesothelin, HE4, MIF, angiopoietin-2, mesothelin, MMP-2, TFMP1-2, tenascin C, Apo A1, factor H, AGRP.
Invention 1.29 Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 following proteins: TFMP1-2, tenascin C, Apo A1, factor H, AGRP, fetuin A.
Inventions 2-39. claims: 1-15(partially) Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising:measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising at least 6 of proteins selected from the group consisting of: FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2, IL-6, IL-8, GROa, MIP-3a, Complement component C2, Complement component C9, Factor D,

The Search Division considers that the present European patent application does not comply with the requirements of unity of invention and relates to several inventions or groups of inventions, namely:

Factor I, MBL, MMP-2, GDF-15, Osteonectin, Periostin, ANGPTL4, FGF-21, FGF-23, HGF, Angiopoietin-2, BMP-9, IL-1RII, HGFR, IL-6ra, OPN, Tenascin-C, Thrombospondin-2, uPAR, CD44, Kallikrein-6, Mesothelin, EpCAM, Apo A1, AGP, A2MB, Fetuin A, HP, L-Selectin, Complement component Clq, Complement component C3, Complement component C3b, Factor B, Factor H, Properdin, AGRP, MMP-12, CYFRA21-1, HE4, total PSA, MIF, AFP, CA125, CA19-9, CA15-3 (MUC-1).
Invention 40. claims: 1-15(partially): Method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject comprising: measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined protein panel comprising the at least 6 proteins selected from the group consisting of: total PSA, EGF, FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a.

The reasons for which the inventions are not so linked as to form a single general inventive concept, as required by Article 82 EPC, are as follows:

(i) The common matter linking together the independent claims 1, 10, 14 and 15 is that at least 6 protein biomarkers are part of a panel and can be measured to assess a colon cell proliferative disorder (such as, to detect colon cell proliferative disorder; to classify and distinguish a population of subjects having a colon cell proliferative disorder from subjects not having the colon cell proliferative disorder; and to determine a protein profile of a biological sample) .

(ii) This common matter does not comprise a single general inventive concept, based on same or corresponding special technical features, because D1 discloses already assessing colon cell proliferative disorder (such as cancer) by measuring the amount of 6 biomarkers from a panel of biomarkers.
Thus D1 recites in para [181]:
"In some embodiments of methods provided herein that include detecting in one or more samples obtained from a subject the presence of: 1) one or more genetic biomarkers in one or more (e.g., 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, ... or 16) of the following genes: NRAS, CTNNB1, PIK3CA, FBXW7, APC, EGFR, BRAF, CDKN2A, PTEN, FGFR2, HRAS, KRAS, AKT1, TP53, PPP2R1A, and/or GNAS, 2) one or more (e.g., 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, or 8) of the following protein biomarkers: CA19-9, CEA, HGF, OPN, CA125, AFP, prolactin, TIMP-1, and/or CA15-3, and 3) the presence of aneuploidy, the subject is determined as having (e.g., diagnosed to have) or is determined to be (e.g. diagnosed as being) at elevated risk of having or developing one of the following types of cancer: liver cancer, ovarian cancer, esophageal cancer, stomach cancer, pancreatic cancer, colorectal cancer, lung cancer, and/or breast cancer."
D1 further recites in para. [344]: "In some embodiments, methods provided herein include detecting the presence of one or more peptides (e.g., one or more peptides that are distinct from the various protein biomarkers described herein as being useful in one or more methods). In some embodiments, a subject is determined to be at elevated risk of having or developing cancer if the biological sample contains one or more peptides indicative of cancer. In some embodiments, a subject is determined as

The Search Division considers that the present European patent application does not comply with the requirements of unity of invention and relates to several inventions or groups of inventions, namely:

having cancer if the biological sample contains one or more peptides indicative of cancer. In some embodiments, a peptide is derived from a protein (e.g., the peptide includes an amino acid sequence present in a protein biomarker or a different protein). Non-limiting examples of peptides indicative of cancer include the following peptides and peptides derived from the following proteins: CEACAM, CYFRA21-1, CA125, ... Kallikrein 6, ... Mesothelin, ...HE4, ... MIF, ... angiopoietin-2, ... CA 19-9, CEA, CA 15-3, CA-50, CA 72-4, OVX1, mesothelin, sialyl TN, MMP-2, -3, -7, -9, VAP-1, TFMP1-2, tenascin C, Apo Al, factor H, AGRP, fetuin A... etc."

D1 also claims: "claim 9. A method for identifying the presence of cancer in a subject comprising: detecting in a first biological sample obtained from the subject the presence of one or more genetic biomarkers in one or more of the following genes: NRAS, CTNNB1, PIK3CA, FBXW7, APC, EGFR, BRAF, CDKN2A, PTEN, FGFR2, HRAS, KRAS, AKT1, TP53, PPP2R1 A, or GNAS; detecting a level of one or more (also 6) of the following protein biomarkers in a second biological sample obtained from the subject: CA19-9, CEA, HGF, OPN, CA125, prolactin, TFMP-1, or MPO; comparing the detected levels of the one or more protein biomarker to one or more reference levels of the protein biomarkers; and identifying the presence of cancer in the subject when the presence of one or more genetic biomarkers is detected, the detected levels of the one or more protein biomarkers are higher than the reference levels of the one or more protein biomarkers, or both.

claim 13. The method of claim 9, wherein the level of each of CA19-9, CEA, HGF, OPN, CA125, prolactin, TIMP-1, and MPO is detected.

claim 15. The method of claim 9, wherein the cancer is liver cancer, ovary cancer, esophageal cancer, stomach cancer, pancreatic cancer, colorectal cancer, lung cancer, breast cancer, or prostate cancer."

D1 also clearly discloses in para. [377] to [378]:

"[377] Applying a mathematical model to the data can generate one or more classifiers. The classifiers are mathematical model with appropriate parameters (e.g., ? coefficient in regression model). These parameters can be determined by applying a mathematical model to a training data set, e.g., a data set that includes both control subjects and a group of subjects that have cancer.

[378] A classifier can be evaluated for its ability to properly characterize each subject in a dataset (e.g., a training dataset or a validation dataset) using methods known to a person of ordinary skill in the art. Various statistical criteria can be used, for example, area under the curve (AUC), percentage of correct predictions, sensitivity, and/or specificity. In some embodiments, the classifier is evaluated by cross validation, Leave One OUT Cross Validation (LOOCV), n-fold cross validation, and jackknife analysis. In some embodiments, each classifier is evaluated for its ability to properly characterize those subjects in a dataset not used to generate the classifier (a "test dataset")."

Also paragraph [0043] of D1 discloses "Figure 8 contains a graph showing i dentification of cancer type by supervised machine learning for patients classified by CancerSEEK as positive. Percentages correspond to the proportion of patients correctly classified by one of the two most likely types (sum of light and dark blue bars) or the most likely type

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(light blue bar). Predictions for all patients for all cancer types are provided in Table 6. Error bars represent 95% confidence intervals." And finally D1 also discloses in paragraph [972]: "The Bioplex 200 platform (Biorad, Hercules CA) was used to determine the concentration of multiple target proteins in the plasma samples. Luminex bead based immunoassays (Millipore, Bil erica NY) were performed following the manufacturers protocols and concentrations were determined using 5 parameter log curve fits (using Bioplex Manager 6.0) with vendor provided standards and quality controls. The HCCBP 1 MAG-58K panel was used to detect FGF2, Osteopontin, sFas, IL-8/CXCL8, Prolactin, HE4, HGF, AFP, CA125, IL6, CA15-3, TGFa, CYFRA21-1, CEA, CA19-9 and Leptin. The HANG2MAG- 12K panel was used to detect PAR, sPECAM-1, TSP-2, sEGFR, AXL and sHER2/sEGFR2/sErbB2. The HCMBMAG-22K panel was used to detect DKK1, GDF15, Osteoprotegerin (OPG) and Neuron-specific enolase (NSE). The HCCBP4MAG- 58K panels was used to detect Kallikrein-6, CD44, Midkine and Mesothelin. The HAGP1MAG-12K panel was used to detect Follistatin, G-CSF, Angiopoietin-2 and (...)"

The common matter is thus disclosed and is not special. The same and corresponding features are not special, hence the above identified single general concept is not novel, let alone inventive, in light of D1 (Rule 44(1) EPC).

As also mentioned during the international phase, D11 discloses a predetermined protein panel characteristic of a colon cell proliferative disorder (methods and kits for identifying a subject as having colon cancer, Para. [0003); values measured for biomarkers of a biomarker panel. Para. (0162); cg27536151 references mitogen-activated protein kinase kinase 5 (MAP2K5). In some embodiments,cg1342U112 references zinc finger protein 512B (ZNF512B). In some embodiments, cg14642259 references myosin binding protein C, cardiac (MYBPC3). Para. [0082], profile comprises six or more biomarkers. Para. [0069]) comprising at least 6 proteins (cg27536151 references mitogen-activated protein kinase kinase 5 (MAP2K5). In some embodiments. cg13420112 references zinc finger protein 512B(ZNF512B) In some embodiments, cg14642259 references myosin binding protein C, cardiac (MYBPC3), Para. (0082); profile comprises six or more biomarkers, Para. (0069)); a classifier configured to distinguish a population of healthy subjects from subjects with a colon cell proliferative disorder (a binary classifier that distinguished two subsets of the total set of classes, Para. [0162); multivariate model scores that distinguish between the presence or absence of colon cancer, between colon cancer subtypes, and between a "good" or a "poor*' prognosis, Para. [0170]) comprising: sets of measured values representative of proteins from a predetermined protein panel characteristic of the colon cell proliferative disorder (methods and kits for identifying a subject as having colon cancer. Para. [0003]; values measured for biomarkers of a biomarker panel. Para. [0082]; profile comprises six or more biomarkers. Para. [0069]), wherein the sets of measured values are obtained from protein expression data from samples of healthy subject and samples of subjects having a colon cell proliferative disorder, wherein the measured values are used to generate a set of

The Search Division considers that the present European patent application does not comply with the requirements of unity of invention and relates to several inventions or groups of inventions, namely:

features corresponding to properties of the protein expression data (methods and kits for identifying a subject as having colon cancer, Para, [0003]; values measure for biomarkers of a biomarker panel, Para. (0162); cg27536151 references mitogen-activated protein kinase kinase 5 (MAP2K5). In some embodiments.cg13420112 references zinc finger protein 512B (ZNF512B). In some embodiments, cg14642259 references myosin binding protein C. cardiac (MYBPC3). Para. [0082]; profile composes six or more biomarkers. In some Instances, the CpG methylation data Is then input into a machine learning/classification program to generate a methylation profile, Para. (0067)), wherein the sets of features is computer-processed using a machine learning or statistical model (a set of biological samples are generated and subsequently input into the machine learning/classification program, Para. [0068]; better prediction is achieved by being more liberal about the biomarker panels used as features, Para. (0163)), and wherein the machine learning or statistical model provides a feature vector useful as a classifier capable of distinguishing a population of healthy subjects from subjects having the colon cell proliferative disorder (the machine learning method utilizes an algorithm selected from one or more of the following: a principal component analysis, a logistic regression analysis, a nearest neighbour analysis, a support vector machine, and a neural network model. Para. (0068); multivariate model scores that distinguish between the presence or absence of colon cancer, between colon cancer subtypes, and between a "good" or a "poor'? prognosis, Para. (0170]) comprising: a computer-readable medium comprising a classifier operable to classify subjects based on a predetermined protein panel (a set of biological samples are generated and subsequently input into the machine learning/classification program. Para. (0068); multivariate model scores that distinguish between the presence or absence of colon cancer, between colon cancer subtypes, and between a "good" or a "poor" prognosis, Para. (0170)); a method for determining a protein profile of a biological sample from a subject (methods and kits for identifying a subject as having colon cancer, Para. (0003); values measured for biomarkers of a biomarker panel, Para (0162); obtained from a biological sample from the subject suspected of having colon cancer. Para. (0004)) composing: a) obtaining the biological sample containing proteins from the subject (obtained from a biological sample from the subject suspected of having colon cancer, Para. [0004]); and b) measuring in the biological sample an amount of a protein from a predetermined panel of proteins comprising at least 6 proteins, thereby providing the protein profile of the subject (methods and kits for identifying a subject as having colon cancer, Para. (0003); values measured for biomarkers of a biomarker panel, Para. (0162); cg27536151 references mitogen-activated protein kinase kinase 5 (MAP2K5). In some embodiments.cg13420112 references zinc finger protein 512B (ZNF512B). In some embodiments, cg14642259 references myosin binding protein C. cardiac (MYBPC3), Para. (0082]; profile comprises six or more biomarkers, Para. [0069]); a method for detecting a colon cell proliferative disorder in a subject (methods and kits for identifying a subject as having colon cancer, Para. (0003), values measured for biomarkers of a biomarker panel. Para. (0162]; obtained from a biological sample from the subject suspected of having colon cancer, Para. [0004]).

The Search Division considers that the present European patent application does not comply with the requirements of unity of invention and relates to several inventions or groups of inventions, namely:

The common matter is thus disclosed and is not special. The same and corresponding features are not special, hence the above identified single general concept is not new, let alone inventive, in light of D11 (Rule 44(1) EPC).

(iii) The common matter linking the biomarkers panel and assessing colon cell proliferative disorder methods according to claims 1, 10, 14 and 15 does not involve any same or corresponding special technical features:
Each partial claims 1, 10, 14 and 15 relate to assessing a colon cell proliferative disorder by determining the level of at least 6 markers from a panel of biomarkers. Each special technical feature relates to at least one protein from a panel of at least 6 biomarkers selected from: EGF, FGF-2, FLT3L, Fractalkine, IL-1a, IL-2, IL-6, IL-8, GROa, MIP-3a, Complement component C2, Complement component C9, Factor D, Factor I, MBL, MMP-2, GDF-15, Osteonectin, Periostin, ANGPTL4, FGF-21, FGF-23, HGF, Angiopoietin-2, BMP-9, IL-1RII, HGFR, IL-6ra, OPN, Tenascin-C, Thrombospondin-2, uPAR, CD44, Kallikrein-6, Mesothelin, EpCAM, Apo A1, AGP, A2MB, Fetuin A, HP, L-Selectin, Complement component Clq, Complement component C3, Complement component C3b, Factor B, Factor H, Properdin, AGRP, MMP-12, CYFRA21-1, HE4, total PSA, MIF, AFP, CA125, CA19-9, CA15-3 (MUC-1), and CEA respectively.
Hence, each partial claims 1, 10, 14 and 15 do not share same or corresponding features.
(iv) As each of the partial claims 1, 10, 14 and 15 comprise neither the same, nor corresponding special technical features, the technical relationship between the subject matter of the claims is lacking and the claims are not so linked as to form a single general inventive concept (Rule 44(2) EPC). The application does not fulfil the requirement for unity of invention (a combination of a posteriori and a priori lack of unity) (Article 82 EPC).
The search for subject 2-40 represent a major extra search burden. In consequence the applicant is invited to pay 39 additional search fees.

ANNEX TO THE EUROPEAN SEARCH REPORT ON EUROPEAN PATENT APPLICATION NO. EP 21 91 1901

This annex lists the patent family members relating to the patent documents cited in the above-mentioned European search report. The members are as contained in the European Patent Office EDP file on
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27-09-2024

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For more details about this annex : see Official Journal of the European Patent Office, No. 12/82

ANNEX TO THE EUROPEAN SEARCH REPORT ON EUROPEAN PATENT APPLICATION NO. EP 21 91 1901

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